Level 3 Adult ESL Curriculum: Scope and Sequence (Draft for Review)

Status: Plan only. No lessons, pictures, audio, or slides have been built yet. Nothing has been published.

Date: October 19, 2026

Audience: Program coordinators and the curriculum author (for review before the full build)

Sits directly above: the Level 2 curriculum (`Level2_Curriculum_v5_public.md`, 13 lessons, Week 8 midterm, Week 15 final, Week 16 graduation). **Sits below:** Level 4 (planned; see `curriculum_plan/Five_Level_Map.md`).

> **Topics:** practical daily life at a higher level: getting to know people better, describing people, life in the past, small car accidents and incidents, helping out, being ready for bad weather, returns and appointments, lost and found, job strengths, following instructions, community events, home repairs, and goals.

How this document is organized

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1. Rationale and research basis	Who Level 3 is for, and the frameworks it is based on
2. Entry and exit skills	What learners can do at the start and at the end
3. Handoff from Level 2 and to Level 4	What Level 3 assumes, what it adds, and what it leaves for Level 4
4. Course design	The weekly routine, language support, grammar format, materials, assessment
5. Semester at a glance	One table for all 16 weeks
6. Week by week	Every lesson: theme, can-do goals, grammar Q&A, words, Talk Time, listening, Read & Write
7. Midterm, final, and graduation	What each one covers and how it works
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1. Rationale and Research Basis

1.1 Why a Level 3, and who it is for

Level 2 graduates can talk about routines, tell a short story in the past, make plans with *going to*, compare things, give simple advice, and handle a short service call. What they usually **can't** do yet is **connect** ideas: give a reason and keep a conversation going, say what was happening when something went wrong, explain what will happen *if* something happens, or describe a person or a problem in detail. Those are the skills adults need at work, at a child's school, with a landlord, and at a store's customer service desk. Level 3 teaches them.

Target learner: an adult who finished Level 2 (or places at that level) and can hold a short, simple conversation on familiar topics. About 95% speak Spanish; the rest speak a range of other languages. Most read and write in their first language. Some are repeating learners who want more speaking practice.

1.2 Level estimates (our estimate, not an official alignment)

Framework	Level 2 (existing)	Level 3 (this course)	Level 4 (planned)
NRS Educational Functioning Levels for ESL (U.S. Department of Education, adult education reporting)	Roughly **High Beginning ESL**	Starts at **High Beginning ESL**; aims to finish at **Low Intermediate ESL**	Low Intermediate → **High Intermediate ESL**
CEFR (Council of Europe; "plus" levels from the 2020 *Companion Volume*)	A1+ → A2	**A2 → A2+**	A2+ → B1
CASAS	Same life-skill content areas (see 1.3). CASAS tests can report learners on the NRS levels. We **do not** claim any score alignment	Same	Same

What these levels describe, in plain words (paraphrased):

- **NRS High Beginning ESL:** the learner understands common words and simple phrases on familiar topics with repetition, can meet basic survival needs, and has some control of basic grammar.
- **NRS Low Intermediate ESL:** the learner understands familiar phrases and some new ones spoken slowly with repetition, can ask and answer questions, can express survival needs, and can take part in some routine social conversations, though with some difficulty. Reading and writing cover simple, short texts on familiar topics.
- **CEFR A2:** the learner handles simple, routine exchanges about familiar matters and can describe their background, surroundings, and immediate needs in simple terms. At A2 the learner can also link ideas

with simple connectors such as *and*, *but*, and *because*. **A2+** is the stronger half of A2: the learner takes a more active part in conversation (with some help) and handles a wider range of everyday situations.

The Level 3 exit goal is NRS Low Intermediate and CEFR A2+, applied to work, family, and community situations. The can-do lists in Section 2 are written to match.

> **Note on test scores:** CASAS publishes score ranges for each NRS level, and the ranges differ by test series and year. Newer NRS descriptors are aligned with the federal English Language Proficiency Standards for adult education. If the program needs scores for reporting, use the current official tables, not this document.

1.3 Content areas (CASAS-style life skills)

Content area	Level 3 lessons
Basic communication (conversation, describing people, giving reasons)	1, 2, 3, 11
Consumer economics (returns, exchanges, refunds, appointments)	7, 8
Community resources (school and community events, lost and found, local events)	5, 8, 11
Health and safety (car and workplace incidents, medicine labels, emergency kits)	4, 6, 10
Employment (helping at work, job strengths, workplace instructions, incident reports)	4, 5, 9, 10
Independent living / housing (home repairs, maintenance requests, power outages)	6, 12
Learning skills (goals, study plans, community college and training)	13, and every week

1.4 Teaching principles (and where they come from)

Principle	What it means in Level 3	Basis
Connect, don't just answer	Every Talk Time requires at least one follow-up question and one reason (*because*, *so*). Answers grow from one sentence to three.	CEFR A2 and A2+ descriptors for linking ideas with simple connectors (*and*, *but*, *because*)
Grammar through real tasks	Each grammar point is tied to one real job: past continuous → reporting an incident; *will* → offering help; *if* → making a plan for bad weather.	Task-based language teaching (for example, Rod Ellis, *Task-Based Language Learning and Teaching*, 2003)
Pictures with every word	Every vocabulary word has a picture card, as in Levels 1 and 2.	Dual coding (Allan Paivio)
Many meetings with each word	Each word appears in New Words, the listening, the grammar box, Talk Time, Read & Write, the homework, and later lessons.	Paul Nation, *Learning Vocabulary in Another Language*
Listen for the main idea, then details	The audio is longer and closer to natural speed, so the first listen is for gist and the second for details.	Common listening-instruction practice (pre-, while-, and post-listening stages)
Notice, then use	The Q&A box shows the form; the "Common mistakes" table and the Spanish note point out the most frequent errors; pairs use the form right away.	Focus on form within meaning-focused tasks
Lots of pair and group talk	Every lesson has at least three pair or group tasks. Target: learners talk for more than half of the class time.	Same principle as Levels 1 and 2

2. Entry and Exit Skills

2.1 Entry (who should start in Level 3)

A learner belongs in Level 3 if, in a short placement chat, they **can** do most of these:

- answer *What do you do every day? What did you do last weekend? What are you going to do this weekend?* in full sentences
- ask a partner 3–4 questions in different tenses (*Do you…? Did you…? Are you going to…?*)
- compare two things (*The bus is cheaper than a taxi*) and give simple advice (*You should rest*)

…but **cannot yet** comfortably do most of these:

- say what they were doing at a moment in the past (*At 8:00 I was cooking*)
- say how life used to be (*I used to live on a farm*)
- say what they will do *if* something happens (*If it rains, I'll take the bus*)

Learners who can't yet do the first list probably belong in Level 2. Learners who can do both lists probably belong in Level 4.

2.2 Exit (what learners can do at the end = what Level 4 expects)

Talking and listening: learners can…

- keep a conversation going with follow-up questions and reasons (*Why? Because… so…*)
- describe a person's appearance and personality, and pick someone out (*She's the tall woman with curly hair*)
- tell how life used to be and compare it with now
- tell what happened in a small car accident or other incident, using *was / were* + *-ing*, *when*, and *while*
- offer help, make promises, and make quick decisions with *will*
- say what will happen *if*…, and make a simple safety plan (storm, power outage)
- return or exchange an item, ask for a refund, and change or cancel an appointment politely
- report a lost item and say who things belong to
- talk about their strengths, skills, and interests in a short job interview
- give and follow step-by-step instructions
- give an opinion of an event or experience with a reason (*It was confusing, so I left early*)
- report a problem at home to a landlord or building manager
- talk about goals and plans with *will*, *going to*, *hope to*, *plan to*, and give a 1–2 minute talk

Reading and writing: learners can…

- read short texts of 80–150 words (flyers, notices, a store policy, a medicine label, short reviews, a short email) and find the main idea and key details
- fill out a multi-part form (incident report, return form, lost-item report, maintenance request)
- write a short note, text message, or email of 3–5 sentences with a reason

Grammar they control (in practiced situations): follow-up questions and *because / so*; *look like / be like*; object pronouns; *used to*; past continuous + *when / while*; *will* (offers, promises, decisions, predictions); first conditional; *I'd like to* + verb and *Could I / May I…?*; possessive pronouns and *Whose…?*; preposition / verb + *-ing* (*good at*, *interested in*, *enjoy*); sequence words + imperatives; *-ed / -ing* adjectives; *some- / any- / no-* words; choosing among future forms.

Deliberately NOT in Level 3 (Level 4 teaches these): present perfect (*Have you ever…? for / since*, *yet*), second conditional (*would*), *might / may* for possibility (Level 3 uses *maybe* and *probably*), *too / enough* as a grammar point (*too big* appears only as a fixed phrase), relative clauses, gerund vs. infinitive contrasts, phrasal verbs as a grammar point, and indirect questions.

3. Handoff from Level 2 and to Level 4

3.1 What Level 2 teaches and Level 3 assumes

Level 3 Lesson 1 opens with a **brief** mixed-tense review, then moves on. Everything below is **not re-taught**; it appears only in the 6:00 Opening Talk, in a homework item, or as support for a new point.

Level 3 assumes learners know…	Level 2 teaches it in	Where Level 3 uses it
be vs. *do* questions; *Wh-* question order	Lesson 1	Lesson 1 (review warm-up), every lesson
Simple present + *-s*; *doesn't*; frequency words	Lesson 2	Lesson 1 review; Lesson 2 (*He's friendly. He always helps me.*)
like / love / hate + *-ing*	Lesson 3	Lesson 9 builds on it (*good at / interested in* + *-ing*)
Present continuous (now and for plans)	Lessons 4, 11	Lesson 4 builds past continuous on it; Lesson 13 future review
was / were; simple past regular and irregular; *Did…?*; *ago*	Lessons 5, 6	Lessons 3, 4, 11 (stories); every Opening Talk
Comparatives and superlatives	Lessons 7, 8	Lesson 2 (*She's taller than her brother*), brief review only
Count / noncount, *some / any*, *How much / many*	Lesson 9	Lesson 12 builds *something / anything* on *some / any*
I'd like + noun; *Can I have…?*	Lesson 9	Lesson 7 adds *I'd like to* + verb
should / shouldn't	Lesson 10	Lessons 4 and 6 (advice after an accident; safety tips), review only
be going to; invitations (*Would you like to…?*)	Lesson 11	Lesson 5 contrasts it with *will*; Lesson 13
have to / need to; *Can / Could you…?*; phone calls	Lesson 12	Lessons 7, 10, 12 (*You have to keep the receipt. Could you send someone?*)
Mixed tenses; *My goal is to…*; a 1-minute talk	Lesson 13	Lesson 1 opening; Lesson 13 extends to *hope to / plan to / will* and a 1–2 minute talk

Items Level 2 passed to Level 3: *will* for offers (Level 2 Lesson 13 shows it to recognize only) → **Level 3 Lesson 5**; object pronouns → **Level 3 Lesson 2**; describing people (Level 2 bonus page only) → **Level 3 Lesson 2**; *because* (modeled in Level 2, not taught) → **Level 3 Lesson 1**.

Planned overlap (on purpose): a few Level 2 words come back with new grammar: *appointment* (Level 2 Lesson 10 → Level 3 Lesson 7, now changing it), *receipt* (Level 2 Lesson 12 → Lesson 7), *fix* (Level 2 Lesson 12 → Lesson 12). They are **not** on the Level 3 picture pages. Otherwise, Level 3 vocabulary is chosen not to repeat Level 1 or Level 2 picture pages.

3.2 What Level 3 gives Level 4

Level 4 will assume…	Level 3 teaches it in	Level 4 builds…
Past continuous + *when / while*	Lesson 4	longer stories; *Were you…ing when…?*
used to	Lesson 3	contrast with present perfect (*I used to…, but now I've…*)
will for offers, decisions, predictions	Lessons 5, 6, 13	*might / may* for possibility
First conditional	Lesson 6	second conditional (*If I had…, I would…*)
I'd like to…; *Could I / May I…?*	Lesson 7	*Would you mind…?*; asking for favors
something / anything / nothing	Lesson 12	*Do you know anyone who…?*; relative clauses
good at / interested in / enjoy + -ing	Lesson 9	verb + *-ing* vs. verb + infinitive
Sequence words + imperatives	Lesson 10	*Don't forget to… / Make sure you…*; time clauses with *before / after*
Reasons with *because / so*; opinions (*I thought it was…*)	Lessons 1, 11	giving and defending opinions; agreeing and disagreeing politely
Writing 3–5 sentences	Read & Write, every week	5–8 sentence emails; a short opinion paragraph

4. Course Design

4.1 Weekly routine (same shape as Level 2, with a Read & Write block)

Learners coming from Level 2 will recognize every step. Level 3 changes three things: the **teacher plays the audio twice** (gist, then details; the file itself plays the conversation once), **Talk Time gets 2 more minutes**, and the last part of class becomes a standing **Read & Write** block.

Clock time	Step	About	What happens
6:00–6:10	1. **Opening Talk + Homework Check**	10 min	Same partner for both. A question card on last week's grammar; partners must ask **one follow-up question**. Then compare homework. The teacher corrects only 2 items on the board. Late arrivals join a pair.
6:10–6:18	2. **New Words**	8 min	Picture page: point, say, repeat; a quick pair game. Learners may add a translation in the **My language** column (optional).
6:18–6:30	3. **Listening + "Say it"**	12 min	Before you listen → **Play 1:** Task A (main idea) → press play again → **Play 2:** Tasks B and C (details, grammar fill-in) → repeat 2 lines. A third play is OK if the class needs it.
6:30–6:45	4. **Grammar Q&A + pair check**	15 min	The two-sided question/answer box; Questions and answers; Common mistakes; then 3–5 minutes of pair practice.
6:45–7:00	**BREAK**	15 min	
7:00–7:12	5. **Talk Time**	12 min	The main pair or group activity of the night. Every Talk Time needs a follow-up question and a reason.
7:12–7:17	6. **Exit Ticket + Homework**	5 min	**Never skip.** Two sentences with today's grammar, one with *because* or *so*. Do homework item 1 together.
7:17–7:30	7. **Read & Write**	13 min	**Recommended for Level 3.** A short real-world text (80–150 words) and a short writing task (a form, a note, a text message). See each lesson.

> **Timing is loose on purpose.** If the listening or Talk Time runs long, take the time from Read & Write. If you're running behind, skip in this order: (1) the Read & Write writing task (it becomes homework); (2) the pair check at the end of Grammar; (3) half of Talk Time. **Never skip** the listening tasks, the grammar box and mistakes table, and the exit ticket.

> **Attendance (15 → 7–8):** use the Level 2 table (pairs, groups, circles, mingles). Every Level 3 activity lists a 15-learner and a 7–8-learner version, and a version for 5 or fewer.

4.2 Language support: tapering from Levels 1 and 2 (decided)

Level 1 puts a Spanish line and a "My language" line under **every** task instruction. Level 2 drops the per-task Spanish lines and keeps one Spanish note and one tip for speakers of other languages per Grammar page. By Level 3, learners know the routine and the task words (*Listen. Circle. Check. Write. Partner.*), so heavy translation now slows them down. But support for **all** first languages should stay fair.

Support	Level 3 recommendation	Why
Instruction icons	**None** (decided: no instruction icons in any level)	Instructions are short, plain English with the same task words every week
Task-words page (first workbook page)	A short list of the task words (*Listen. Circle. Check. Write. Work with a partner.*) with an *Español* and a *My language* column	One page of translation replaces hundreds of lines
Spanish line under each instruction	**None** (decided; as in Level 2)	Learners know the task words; instructions stay short and in English
"My language" line under each instruction	**None**; replaced by a **My language column on the New Words page** (decided)	A personal bilingual word list is more useful at this level than translated instructions
Spanish note on the Grammar page	**Keep**, one short note per lesson (decided; student pages only)	The most common errors are still Spanish-transfer errors
Tip for speakers of other languages	**Keep**, one per lesson (decided)	Fairness for non-Spanish speakers; written so any learner can use it
Teacher pages	English only, as always	Teachers need no Spanish

> **Teacher-friendly:** volunteers never read, translate, or explain the Spanish notes. When a learner is stuck: show it (picture, gesture, board), give one more English example, point to the task words and the grammar box, let a classmate help for a few seconds, then back to English.

4.3 Grammar format: two-sided question-and-answer boxes

Same format as Levels 1 and 2: the question side on the left, the answer side on the right, one word from each column. Each box has a short "Questions and answers" section in plain English, a "Common mistakes" table (✗ → ✓), a Spanish note, and a tip for speakers of other languages (student pages only). Level 3 boxes are a little longer (up to 5 rows) and often have a third column for a reason or a time clause. Example (Lesson 4):

QUESTION		
What **were**	you they	doing?
What **was**	he she	doing?
Were	you	driving?
What	**happened**	then?

ANSWER		
I **was** They **were**	carrying	a box. boxes.
He She **was**	waiting	for the bus. for a ride.
Yes,	I	**was**.
No,	I	**wasn't**.
I **was** driving	**when**	a car hit my car. the light changed.

4.4 Materials per lesson (same as Levels 1 and 2)

Item	Level 3 detail
Student Workbook pages	New Words (with a *My language* column), Listening, Grammar, Talk Time sheet, Homework, and a Read & Write page. No instruction icons. Same page look as Level 2.
Pictures	12 per lesson (≈ 156 total), 600×420 PNG cards made from Twemoji graphics (CC BY 4.0), same style and naming as Levels 1–2 (Level 3 pictures are named `L3_L<lesson>_<word>.png`, for example `L3_L4_stop_sign.png`, so they never collide with Level 1–2 files). Abstract words (*reason*, *reliable*, *reschedule*, *store credit*, *maintenance request*) get a labeled combination of two emoji or a simple form picture with the field highlighted. Every picture gets a line in `CREDITS.md`.
Listening audio	One MP3 per lesson + midterm + final (15 files), Chatterbox TTS cloned from **synthetic reference voices only** (no recordings of real people). **About 1:30 (1:15–1:45)**, up to 3 speakers (for example a narrator and two characters), natural speed with clear speech and natural pauses. Female characters have clearly female voices and male characters male voices. Each file plays the conversation **once** (it never repeats inside the file); the teacher presses play again for the second listen.
Slides	One deck per lesson, same look as Level 2: picture words, listening tasks, the grammar box with click-to-reveal answers, Talk Time instructions, and the Read & Write text.
Teacher plan	At a glance, clock-time plan, step-by-step boxes, listening script, answer key, and teacher notes in plain English. Every step says exactly what to say and show. **Teachers need no Spanish.**

4.5 Assessment and progress

Tool	When	What
Placement chat	Before Week 1 or on Week 1 night	3–4 minutes: the entry questions in Section 2.1. Decides Level 2, 3, or 4.
Baseline snapshot	Weeks 1–3	The same 6 prompts every time: *Tell me about your week. What did you do last weekend? What are you going to do next month? Describe a friend. What was your life like as a child? What will you do if it rains on Saturday?* About 5 learners per week during Talk Time. The final uses the same prompts to show growth.
Can-do self-check	Weeks 1, 8, 15	"I can…" lines + 😀 🙂 😐, read aloud by the teacher.
Exit ticket	Every lesson	Two sentences with today's grammar, one with a reason.
Homework	Every lesson	15 minutes: a short writing task, a speaking task with a family member or coworker, and one older grammar point.
Read & Write tasks	Most lessons	Collected every two weeks; the teacher writes one strength and one fix.
Midterm / Final	Weeks 8, 15	Listening (the teacher plays the audio 2 times), grammar (circle + fix the mistake), a short writing task, and a pair speaking interview with the same 1–3 rubric as Level 2. Section 7.

5. The Semester at a Glance

Week	Class	Grammar Q&A focus	Real-life function
1	**Lesson 1 (Week 1):** Tell Me More	Mixed-tense questions (review); follow-up questions; *Why…? Because… / …, so…*	Keep a conversation going; meet classmates and neighbors
2	**Lesson 2 (Week 2):** Who's Who?	*What does she look like? / What's she like?*; object pronouns (*me*, *him*, *her*, *us*, *them*)	Describe people; find someone you've never met
3	**Lesson 3 (Week 3):** When I Was Young	*used to / didn't use to*; *Did you use to…?*	Compare life then and now
4	**Lesson 4 (Week 4):** It Happened So Fast	Past continuous; *when / while* + simple past	Report an accident or incident; fill out an incident report
5	**Lesson 5 (Week 5):** Don't Worry, I'll Do It	*will* for offers, promises, quick decisions; *will* vs. *going to*	Offer help at work, at home, and at a school event
6	**Lesson 6 (Week 6):** Be Ready	First conditional (*If…, …will…*); *will* + *probably / maybe* for predictions	Weather alerts, power outages, an emergency plan
7	**Lesson 7 (Week 7):** Can I Exchange This?	*I'd like to* + verb; *Could I / Can I / May I…?*; reasons with *because*	Return or exchange an item; change or cancel an appointment
8	**Week 8: Midterm**	Review of Lessons 1–7	Review stations + exam
9	**Lesson 8 (Week 9):** Lost and Found	*Whose…?*; possessive pronouns (*mine*, *yours*, *his*, *hers*, *ours*, *theirs*)	Report and describe a lost item; say who owns what
10	**Lesson 9 (Week 10):** My Strengths	*good at / interested in / bad at* + *-ing*; *enjoy / don't mind* + *-ing*	Talk about skills and strengths in a job interview
11	**Lesson 10 (Week 11):** Step by Step	Sequence words (*first*, *next*, *then*, *after that*, *finally*) + imperatives; *How do I…?*	Give and follow instructions at home, at work, and on a label
12	**Lesson 11 (Week 12):** Bored or Boring?	*-ed / -ing* adjectives; *How was it? I thought it was…*	Give an opinion of an event; read and write a short review
13	**Lesson 12 (Week 13):** Something's Wrong	*something / anything / nothing*; *someone / anyone / no one*; *somewhere / anywhere*	Report a problem at home; ask for a repair
14	**Lesson 13 (Week 14):** Where I'm Going	Future review: *will*, *going to*, present continuous; *hope to / plan to / want to* + verb; *I hope (that) I'll…*	Talk about goals; prepare the graduation talk
15	**Week 15: Final Exam**	Review of all lessons (focus on 8–13)	Review stations + exam
16	**Week 16: Graduation**	—	1–2 minute "Where I'm Going" talks; certificates

Grammar in teaching order: 1. follow-up questions + *because / so* (L1) → 2. *look like / be like*; object pronouns (L2) → 3. *used to* (L3) → 4. past continuous + *when / while* (L4) → 5. *will* for offers and decisions; *will* vs. *going to* (L5) → 6. first conditional; *will* for predictions (L6) → 7. *I'd like to* + verb; *Could I / May I* (L7) → **midterm** → 8. possessive pronouns; *Whose* (L8) → 9. preposition / verb + *-ing* (L9) → 10. sequence

words + imperatives (L10) → 11. *-ed / -ing* adjectives (L11) → 12. *some- / any- / no-* words (L12) → 13. future forms together (L13) → **final**.

Spiral recycling: every Opening Talk reuses last week's questions, and every homework mixes in one older point. *because / so* (Lesson 1) and *will* (Lessons 5–6) come back in almost every lesson after they are taught. The past continuous (Lesson 4) returns in Lesson 8 (*I was waiting for the bus when I lost it*), and the first conditional (Lesson 6) returns in Lessons 7 and 12 (*If it doesn't fit, can I return it? If you don't fix it, I'll call again*).

6. Week by Week

Vocabulary: ★ = most important words. Each word gets a picture card. "Talk Time" is the main pair or group activity (7:00–7:12); each lesson also has pair work in New Words, Listening, and Grammar. The teacher plays the audio twice: Task A on the first play, Tasks B and C on the second.

Lesson 1 (Week 1): Tell Me More

Part	Plan
Theme	First night: getting to know classmates beyond the basics; how to keep a conversation going. Includes orientation, the task-words page, and the first can-do self-check.
Can-do goals	I can ask a follow-up question. • I can give a reason with *because*. • I can say a result with *so*. • I can talk about my week, my past, and my plans in one conversation.
Grammar Q&A focus	**Review (5 min):** *Do you…? Did you…? Are you going to…?* • **New:** follow-up questions: *Really? Why? What happened? How was it? What about you?* • *Why do you take the bus?* → *Because it's cheap.* • *I was tired, so I stayed home.* (*because* = reason; *so* = result)
Vocabulary (12)	★ neighbor • ★ coworker • ★ small talk • ★ follow-up question • ★ reason • ★ good news • ★ bad news • ★ chat • ★ introduce • community center • volunteer • get along
Talk Time	**Three-Question Rule (inside–outside circles):** A asks one question from a card; B answers; A must ask **two follow-up questions** before the circle moves. Each round, B must use *because* or *so* once. 15 learners: two circles; 7–8: one circle; 5 or fewer: rotate seats.
Listening	Two neighbors chat in a laundromat about their week; one has good news (a new job) and one has bad news (a broken car). **Tasks:** A: good news or bad news? B: true/false; C: write *because* or *so*.
Read & Write	A community center flyer (classes, hours, a volunteer request). Write 3 sentences about a classmate, one with *because*.
Pronunciation	Rising intonation on short follow-ups (*Really?* ↗ *Why?* ↘); sounding interested.
Spanish note	*Why?* = *¿Por qué?* and *because* = *porque*: two different words in English. *So* here means *entonces / por eso*.
Tip for other languages	In English, a one-word answer can sound unfriendly. Add a reason or a question back.
Teacher tip	Model a "dead" conversation (one-word answers), then a good one with follow-ups. Learners hear the difference right away.

Lesson 2 (Week 2): Who's Who?

Part	Plan
Theme	Describing people's looks and personality: a new coworker, a relative, a person you need to meet at the bus station.
Can-do goals	I can describe how someone looks. • I can describe someone's personality. • I can ask *What does he look like? What's he like?* • I can use *me, him, her, us, them*.
Grammar Q&A focus	*What does she look like? → She's tall. She has curly hair and glasses.* • *What's he like? → He's friendly and funny.* • *Which one is your sister? → The woman with long hair.* • Object pronouns: *Do you know Ana? → Yes, I work with her. She always helps me.* • Comparatives as brief review: *She's taller than me.*
Vocabulary (12)	★ tall • ★ short • ★ curly hair • ★ straight hair • ★ beard • ★ glasses • ★ friendly • ★ shy • ★ funny • ★ hardworking • patient • quiet
Talk Time	**Pick Them Up (information gap):** A has a card: "Pick up my cousin at the bus station" with a picture of the cousin. A describes the person; B finds them in a crowd picture of 12 people and points. Then switch. Second round: groups of 3 describe a person they admire (personality only), and others ask one follow-up.
Listening	A supervisor tells a new worker about two coworkers she will meet (who to ask for help, who is shy). **Tasks:** A: point to the right people; B: match person → personality word; C: write *him / her / them*.
Read & Write	A short "welcome" email to a new employee describing the team. Write 3–4 sentences describing a friend or family member.
Pronunciation	Word stress in adjectives (*FRIENDly, HARDworking, PAtient*).
Spanish note	*What's he like?* = *¿Cómo es?* (personality); *What does he look like?* = *¿Cómo es físicamente? She has long hair* (not *hairs*); adjectives never take *-s* (*two tall men*).
Tip for other languages	English always needs an object word after many verbs: *I know her* (not *I know*).
Teacher tip	Describe **only** hair, height, glasses, beards, clothes, and personality. Never use words about weight, skin color, or age as a joke. The crowd picture is invented.

Lesson 3 (Week 3): When I Was Young

Part	Plan
Theme	Childhood and life in the past; how things have changed (technology, chores, school, communication).
Can-do goals	I can say what I used to do. • I can say what I didn't use to do. • I can ask *Did you use to…?* • I can compare then and now.
Grammar Q&A focus	*What did you use to do after school? → I used to help on the farm.* • *Did you use to walk to school? → Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.* • *I didn't use to drink coffee. Now I drink it every day.* • *used to* (past habits) vs. simple past (one time) vs. simple present (now).
Vocabulary (12)	★ childhood • ★ village • ★ farm • ★ river • ★ climb trees • ★ chores • ★ feed the animals • ★ radio • ★ letter (mail) • ★ landline phone • jump rope • then / now
Talk Time	**Then and Now Mingle:** a sheet with 8 prompts (*used to have a radio / used to walk far to school / didn't use to cook*). Learners find a classmate for each and ask one follow-up (*Where? Why?*). Then groups of 3: each person says 3 sentences comparing then and now.
Listening	A grandmother and her adult son look at an old photo and talk about how life used to be in her town. **Tasks:** A: then or now? B: check what she used to do; C: write *used to* or *use to*.
Read & Write	A short memory story (about 100 words) from an invented learner. Write 4 sentences: 2 *used to*, 2 *now*.
Pronunciation	*used to* sounds like "yoos-tuh"; *use* (verb) vs. *used to*.
Spanish note	*used to* is like *-aba / -ía* (*jugaba*, *vivía*) or *solía*: *I used to play = Jugaba*. In questions and negatives use *use*: *Did you use to…? I didn't use to…*
Tip for other languages	*used to* is only for the past. For now, say *I usually….*
Teacher tip	Learners choose what to share. Childhood can be hard for some people; "a place I used to live" or "a job I used to have" are always OK alternatives.

Lesson 4 (Week 4): It Happened So Fast

Part	Plan
Theme	A simple, non-graphic car accident (a small crash at an intersection; no one is hurt): what people were doing, and reporting it to an insurance agent. A minor workplace incident (a spilled box, a wet floor) is an optional alternative.
Can-do goals	I can say what I was doing at a time in the past. • I can tell what happened with *when* and *while*. • I can answer questions about a small car accident. • I can fill out a simple accident report.
Grammar Q&A focus	*What were you doing at 8:00? → I was driving to work.* • *Was anyone hurt? → No, everyone was OK.* • *What happened? → I was waiting at the light when a car hit my car.* • *While I was turning left, the other driver was talking on the phone.* • Past continuous (longer action) + simple past (short action). Brief review of *should*: *You should tell your supervisor.*
Vocabulary (12)	★ accident • ★ intersection • ★ traffic light • ★ stop sign • ★ hit (a car) • ★ dent • ★ driver • ★ police officer • ★ witness • ★ insurance card • ★ report • wet floor (workplace option)
Talk Time	**Witness:** A looks at a busy street picture for 30 seconds (B does not see it). B asks *What was the man doing? Was anyone crossing the street?* and fills in a witness form. Then they look together and check. Switch with a second picture (a parking lot; or a warehouse with a wet floor as the workplace option).
Listening	A driver calls an insurance line about a small accident at an intersection: what she was doing, what the other driver was doing, and that no one was hurt. **Tasks:** A: where did it happen? B: put the events in order; C: write *was / were*.
Read & Write	A one-page accident report (date, time, place, what you were doing, what happened, witnesses). Learners fill it in for an invented picture story.
Pronunciation	Weak *was* /wəz/ and *were* /wər/ in sentences; strong forms in short answers.
Spanish note	*I was driving* = *Estaba manejando*. The short action uses the simple past: *when the phone rang* (not *was ringing*).
Tip for other languages	Long action = *was / were* + *-ing*. Short action that interrupts = past tense.
Teacher tip	Keep it simple and non-graphic: dents, not injuries. Never ask about real accidents, injuries, or experiences with the police. Use the picture stories. Say: "In a real emergency, call 911."

Lesson 5 (Week 5): Don't Worry, I'll Do It

Part	Plan
Theme	Offering help and making promises: at work, with a neighbor, and at a children's school event.
Can-do goals	I can offer help with *I'll…*. • I can make a promise. • I can make a quick decision. • I can tell the difference between *will* and *going to*.
Grammar Q&A focus	*The phone's ringing.* → *I'll get it.* • *Can someone bring chairs?* → *I'll bring them.* • *Will you call me?* → *Yes, I will. I promise. / Don't worry, I won't forget.* • *Shall I…? / Do you want me to…?* (recognize) • *will* (decide now) vs. *going to* (planned before): *I'm going to bake a cake. (I planned it.) / OK, I'll bring drinks. (I decide now.)*
Vocabulary (12)	★ offer • ★ promise • ★ carry • ★ set up • ★ clean up • ★ bring • ★ lend • ★ give a ride • ★ call back • ★ text • school event • flyer
Talk Time	**Problem / Offer Cards + Event Board:** Round 1: A reads a problem card (*My car won't start. I have too many boxes.*); B offers help with *I'll…*; A says thank you. Round 2: groups plan a park cleanup or a school family night on a task board; each person volunteers for two jobs with *I'll…* and one *I'm going to…* already planned.
Listening	Parents organize a school family night by phone: who will bring food, who will set up, and someone who promises to call back. **Tasks:** A: what is the event? B: match person → job; C: write *'ll* or *going to*.
Read & Write	A volunteer sign-up sheet and a school flyer. Write a short text message offering help (*Hi Rosa, I'll bring…*).
Pronunciation	Contractions *I'll*, *you'll*, *we'll* (/aɪl/); *won't* vs. *want*.
Spanish note	Spanish often uses the present for offers (*¿Te ayudo? Yo lo traigo*). English needs *will*: *I'll help you* (not *I help you*).
Tip for other languages	*will* never changes: *I will*, *she will*, *they will*. No *-s*, no *to*.
Teacher tip	Any event in Talk Time is invented. Volunteering is an example, not a request.

Lesson 6 (Week 6): Be Ready

Part	Plan
Theme	Weather alerts, storms, heat, and power outages; what to do *if…*; an emergency kit and a family plan.
Can-do goals	I can understand a weather forecast. • I can say what will happen *if…*. • I can make a simple emergency plan. • I can make predictions with *probably* and *maybe*.
Grammar Q&A focus	*What will you do if the power goes out? → If the power goes out, I'll use a flashlight.* • *If it snows tomorrow, will school be closed? → Maybe. / Probably.* • *It will probably rain. It probably won't snow.* • After *if*, use the present: *If it rains* (not *If it will rain*). Brief *should* review for safety tips.
Vocabulary (12)	★ forecast • ★ storm • ★ snowstorm • ★ flood • ★ heat wave • ★ weather alert • ★ power outage • ★ flashlight • ★ battery • ★ emergency kit • ★ bottled water • shelter
Talk Time	**What If? Chain + Ready Plan:** Round 1: a chain around the group (*If it snows, I'll stay home. → If I stay home, I'll cook soup. → If I cook soup…*). Round 2: groups get a scenario card (storm, heat wave, power outage), write 4 *If…, we'll…* sentences and an emergency kit list, and present them in 1 minute.
Listening	A radio-style weather alert, then two roommates decide what they'll do if the power goes out tonight. **Tasks:** A: what is the weather problem? B: check the items they need; C: write *will / won't* or the *if* verb.
Read & Write	A weather alert text message and an emergency kit checklist. Fill in a "My Ready Plan" card (who to call, where to go, 3 things to keep).
Pronunciation	Linking with *'ll* (*it'll* "id-ul", *we'll*); stress on the key words in *if* sentences.
Spanish note	Same pattern as Spanish *si + presente*: *If it rains, I'll stay = Si llueve, me quedo / me quedaré.* English needs *it*: *If **it** rains* (not *If rains*).
Tip for other languages	Never put *will* right after *if*. Put *will* in the other half of the sentence.
Teacher tip	Choose the weather that fits your area (snow, heat, floods). Keep candles out of practice plans (fire risk); use flashlights. Use local alert systems only as examples, not real sign-ups in class.

Lesson 7 (Week 7): Can I Exchange This?

Part	Plan
Theme	Customer service: returning or exchanging an item, asking for a refund, and changing or canceling an appointment by phone.
Can-do goals	I can say *I'd like to return / exchange this*. • I can give a reason. • I can ask for permission with *Could I / May I…?* • I can change or cancel an appointment.
Grammar Q&A focus	*Can I help you? → Yes, I'd like to return this shirt.* • *Why? / What's wrong with it? → Because it's too small. / It's broken.* (*too small* as a fixed phrase) • *Could I exchange it for a large? → Sure. / Sorry, you need the receipt.* • *May I speak to the manager?* • *I'd like to change my appointment. → What day is good for you?* • Review: *I'd like* + noun (Level 2) → *I'd like to* + verb (new).
Vocabulary (12)	★ return • ★ exchange • ★ refund • ★ store credit • ★ size • ★ broken • ★ customer • ★ manager • ★ cancel • ★ reschedule • ★ available • stain
Talk Time	**Service Desk:** half the class are clerks with a store policy card (30 days, receipt needed, store credit only for some items); half are customers with a problem card. Customers return or exchange; clerks follow the policy. Switch. Round 2 (phone, back to back): reschedule an appointment using a calendar slip.
Listening	A customer returns a phone case at a service desk (no receipt, gets store credit); then a short call to change a clinic appointment. **Tasks:** A: return or exchange? B: circle the reason and the new day; C: write *like / like to*.
Read & Write	A store return policy (invented store). Fill in a return form (item, reason, refund or exchange).
Pronunciation	Polite intonation for requests (*Could I…?* ↗); *I'd like to* linked ("I'd-like-tuh").
Spanish note	*I'd like to return this = Quisiera devolver esto. Return = devolver*; *exchange = cambiar*. *May I…?* is very polite, like *¿Me permite…?*
Tip for other languages	After *I'd like* use a thing (*I'd like a bag*). After *I'd like to* use a verb (*I'd like to return it*).
Teacher tip	Use only invented stores and policies. Play money is not needed. Learners never talk about their own purchases or money.

Week 8: Midterm (Review Stations + Exam)

See Section 7. Covers Lessons 1–7. No new content.

Lesson 8 (Week 9): Lost and Found

Part	Plan
Theme	Losing and finding things; describing a lost item; a lost-and-found office at a bus station, a store, or a school.
Can-do goals	I can ask *Whose… is this?* • I can say *It's mine / It's hers*. • I can describe a lost item. • I can fill out a lost-item report.
Grammar Q&A focus	*Whose umbrella is this? → It's mine. / It's Ana's. / I think it's his.* • *Is this yours? → No, it isn't mine. Maybe it's theirs.* • *Whose keys are these? → They're ours.* • Possessive pronouns *mine*, *yours*, *his*, *hers*, *ours*, *theirs* vs. adjectives (*my*, *your*…) from Level 1. • Describing: *It's a small black wallet with a zipper*. Past continuous recycles: *I was waiting for the bus when I lost it.*
Vocabulary (12)	★ wallet • ★ purse • ★ keys • ★ umbrella • ★ backpack • ★ sunglasses • ★ headphones • ★ gloves • ★ scarf • ★ lost and found • ★ belong to • describe
Talk Time	**The Lost and Found Box:** each learner gets a picture card of an item (some identical except one detail). A "clerk" holds the box of cards. Owners fill out a short lost-item form, then describe the item; the clerk asks *Is this yours? Whose is this?* Round 2: mixed-up table: groups sort items with *This is mine. That's hers.*
Listening	A man calls a bus company's lost and found about a backpack; the agent asks him to describe it and what he was doing when he lost it. **Tasks:** A: what did he lose? B: circle the details (color, size, what was inside); C: write *his / mine / yours*.
Read & Write	A lost-item report form; a "FOUND" notice on a community board. Write a short FOUND notice.
Pronunciation	Final /z/ in *yours*, *hers*, *ours*, *theirs*; *whose* and *who's* sound the same.
Spanish note	*mine = (el / la) mío / mía*, but English uses no *the*: *It's mine* (not *It's the mine*). *His* (de él) and *hers* (de ella) are different words; Spanish *suyo* covers both.
Tip for other languages	Possessive pronouns stand alone (*It's mine*); possessive adjectives need a noun (*my bag*).
Teacher tip	Use picture cards, not learners' real belongings. Remind learners not to share real ID numbers on any form.

Lesson 9 (Week 10): My Strengths

Part	Plan
Theme	Skills, strengths, and interests for work; a short job interview; reading a job ad.
Can-do goals	I can say what I'm good at. • I can say what I'm interested in. • I can talk about my experience. • I can answer *Tell me about yourself* in 3–4 sentences.
Grammar Q&A focus	*What are you good at? → I'm good at fixing things. / I'm good with people.* • *Are you interested in learning new skills? → Yes, I'm very interested in working with computers.* • *Do you enjoy working on a team? → Yes, I enjoy helping people. I don't mind working weekends.* • After a preposition (*at*, *in*, *about*), use *-ing*. Builds on Level 2 *like* + *-ing* and Level 1 *can*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ strength • ★ good at • ★ interested in • ★ experience • ★ reliable • ★ teamwork • ★ organize • ★ solve problems • ★ résumé • ★ apply • ★ training • shift
Talk Time	**Interview Rotation:** inside–outside circles; the inner circle are managers with an invented job card (warehouse, hotel, kitchen, childcare), the outer circle are applicants. Managers ask 3 questions from a card and one follow-up; applicants answer with *good at / interested in / enjoy*. Rotate 3 times, then switch roles.
Listening	A short interview for a hotel maintenance job: the applicant talks about strengths, experience, and the shifts she can work. **Tasks:** A: does she get a second interview? B: check her strengths; C: write the *-ing* word.
Read & Write	Two short job ads (invented employers). Write a 3-sentence "skills summary" for yourself or an invented person.
Pronunciation	/ŋ/ at the end of *-ing* words; stress in *INterested*, *exPERience*.
Spanish note	After *at / in / about* English uses *-ing*: *good at cooking* (Spanish: *bueno para cocinar*, with the infinitive). *Interested in* (not *interested on*).
Tip for other languages	In an interview, give an example after each strength: *I'm reliable. I was never late at my last job.*
Teacher tip	Invite, don't require, real job details. Learners can use an invented job history. Avoid questions about immigration or work status.

Lesson 10 (Week 11): Step by Step

Part	Plan
Theme	Giving and following instructions: using a machine at a laundromat, a safety step at work, logging in to a website, and reading a medicine label.
Can-do goals	I can give instructions in order. • I can follow instructions. • I can ask *How do I…? What do I do next?* • I can read a medicine label.
Grammar Q&A focus	*How do I use this machine? → First, put in the clothes. Next, add the detergent. Then, press START.* • *What do I do after that? → After that, wait 30 minutes.* • *Don't open the door. Don't forget to take your card.* • Imperatives with sequence words (*first*, *next*, *then*, *after that*, *finally*). *You have to / You need to* as brief review (Level 2).
Vocabulary (12)	★ instructions • ★ step • ★ press • ★ plug in • ★ turn on / turn off • ★ laundry • ★ detergent • ★ safety goggles • ★ label • ★ tablet (medicine) • ★ password • log in
Talk Time	**Teach Me in Four Steps:** each pair gets a jumbled 4-picture strip (sending a photo by phone, making a pot of coffee at work, washing hands at work, paying at a parking machine). A puts the strip in order and teaches B with sequence words; B mimes each step. Switch with a new strip. With 5 or fewer: one learner teaches the group.
Listening	A new worker gets instructions from a coworker on using the floor cleaning machine; then a pharmacist explains how to take a medicine. **Tasks:** A: what machine? B: number the steps 1–5; C: write the sequence word.
Read & Write	A medicine label (*Take 1 tablet every 8 hours with food. Do not take more than 3 tablets in 24 hours.*) with questions; write 4 steps for a task you know.
Pronunciation	/ð/ in *then* and *the*; /θ/ in *third*; pausing between steps.
Spanish note	Commands in English have no *you* and no ending: *Press START* (not *You press* or *Presses*). Negative: *Don't* + verb: *Don't open*.
Tip for other languages	Listen for the sequence words. They tell you when a new step starts.
Teacher tip	The medicine label is invented and for reading practice only; tell learners to ask a pharmacist about real medicine.

Lesson 11 (Week 12): Bored or Boring?

Part	Plan
Theme	Community events (a festival, a concert, a fair, a museum, a workshop): how they were and how people felt; giving an opinion with a reason; reading and writing short reviews.
Can-do goals	I can say how something was (*It was interesting*). • I can say how I felt (*I was interested*). • I can give an opinion with a reason. • I can write a short review.
Grammar Q&A focus	*How was the concert? → It was exciting! / It was boring.* • *How did you feel? → I was excited. / I was bored.* • *Was the workshop interesting? → Yes, it was. I was very interested.* • *I thought it was confusing, so I left early.* • *-ing* = the thing / the experience; *-ed* = the person's feeling. Simple past recycles.
Vocabulary (12)	★ exciting / excited • ★ boring / bored • ★ interesting / interested • ★ confusing / confused • ★ relaxing / relaxed • ★ tiring / tired • ★ surprising / surprised • ★ festival • ★ concert • ★ museum • fair • review (stars)
Talk Time	**Star Ratings:** each learner gets an event card (or tells about a real one), tells a partner how it was and how they felt, with one reason. The partner asks two follow-ups and gives it 1–5 stars. Round 2: groups agree on "the best weekend event" for the class bulletin board and give two reasons.
Listening	Two coworkers talk on Monday about a food festival and a museum workshop they went to over the weekend. **Tasks:** A: did they like it? (😀 / 😐) B: match the event → the adjective; C: write *-ed* or *-ing*.
Read & Write	Three short online reviews (invented events, 40–60 words each). Write a 3–4 sentence review with stars and one reason.
Pronunciation	*-ed* endings review /t/ /d/ /ɪd/ (*relaxed*, *bored*, *interested*).
Spanish note	Spanish uses one word (*aburrido*); English uses two: *I'm bored* (*estoy aburrido*), *It's boring* (*es aburrido*). Careful: *I'm boring* means *soy aburrido*.
Tip for other languages	People usually *feel* the *-ed* word. Things and experiences *are* the *-ing* word.
Teacher tip	Use only general community events. Learners can talk about a TV show or a sports game instead.

Lesson 12 (Week 13): Something's Wrong

Part	Plan
Theme	Problems at home (leaks, heat, locks, pests, a smoke alarm); calling or writing to a landlord or building manager; scheduling a repair.
Can-do goals	I can say what's wrong in my home. • I can use *something / anything / nothing*. • I can ask for a repair and set a time. • I can write a short maintenance request.
Grammar Q&A focus	*Is anything wrong? → Yes, something is wrong with the heater.* • *Is anyone home on Tuesday? → Yes, someone is home after 3. / No, no one is home.* • *Did you see anything? → No, I didn't see anything. / I saw nothing.* • *Can you send someone today? → I'll send someone tomorrow morning.* • *some-* in positive sentences; *any-* in questions and negatives; *no-* alone (one negative only). First conditional recycles: *If it gets worse, I'll call you.*
Vocabulary (12)	★ landlord • ★ repair person • ★ maintenance request • ★ leak • ★ sink • ★ toilet • ★ heater • ★ light bulb • ★ lock • ★ smoke alarm • mouse • cockroach
Talk Time	**The Repair Call (back to back):** A is a tenant with a problem card and a calendar; B is a building manager with a repair schedule. They agree on what's wrong and when someone can come. Switch. Round 2: "Find something" picture game: in an apartment picture, pairs find 6 problems and say *There's something wrong with… / There isn't anything in….*
Listening	A tenant calls the building office about a leaking sink and a heater that doesn't work; the manager asks questions and sets a time. **Tasks:** A: which problems? B: circle the day and time; C: write *some / any / no + thing / one*.
Read & Write	A maintenance request form and a sample note. Write a 3–5 sentence request: the problem, since when, the best time, and a phone number (invented).
Pronunciation	Stress in compound words (*SOMEthing*, *ANYone*, *NObody*); /θ/ in *thing* (not "ting").
Spanish note	Spanish uses two negatives (*No veo nada*). English uses only one: *I don't see anything* or *I see nothing* (not *I don't see nothing*).
Tip for other languages	In questions, *anything* and *anyone* are the safe choice: *Is anything wrong?*
Teacher tip	Keep it practical and invented. Never ask about learners' real rent, landlords, or living situation. Tenant rights are a Level 5 topic; here, refer learners to local resources on the "Keep practicing" sheet.

Lesson 13 (Week 14): Where I'm Going

Part	Plan
Theme	Goals for work, school, and family; next steps such as a class, a certificate, or a driver's license; preparing the graduation talk.
Can-do goals	I can talk about a plan with *going to*. • I can talk about hopes with *hope to / I hope I'll*. • I can say what I will do to reach a goal. • I can give a 1–2 minute talk about my goals.
Grammar Q&A focus	*What are you going to do next year? → I'm going to take a computer class.* (plan) • *What do you hope to do? → I hope to get my diploma. / I hope I'll have my own business.* • *What will you do first? → First, I'll ask about classes at the community college.* • *I'm meeting the counselor on Monday.* (fixed plan, review) • *plan to / want to / hope to* + verb. Builds on Level 2 *My goal is to….*
Vocabulary (12)	★ plan • ★ hope • ★ decide • ★ diploma • ★ certificate • ★ career • ★ promotion • ★ save money • ★ own business • ★ driver's license • ★ computer class • community college
Talk Time	**Goal Ladder + Talk Rehearsal:** each learner draws a 3-step ladder for one goal (step 1: *I'll…*; step 2: *I'm going to…*; top: *I hope to…*), then explains it to a partner, who asks two follow-ups. Then groups of 3 rehearse the graduation talk (Then → Now → Next, with a reason); listeners give one 👍 and one tip on a feedback card.
Listening	A former Level 3 learner gives a short talk about her goals: a certificate, a better job, and helping her kids with homework. **Tasks:** A: what is her main goal? B: put her steps in order; C: write *will / going to / hope to*.
Read & Write	A community college flyer (invented: class names, days, cost "free"). Write the graduation talk (6–8 sentences) using the talk frame.
Pronunciation	Pausing and sentence stress in a short speech; *going to* → "gonna" (recognize, don't require).
Spanish note	*I hope to…* = *Espero…* + infinitive (*Espero conseguir…*). *I hope I'll…* = *Espero que….* English doesn't need a special verb form after *I hope*.
Tip for other languages	*going to* = already planned. *will* = decided now or a promise. *hope to* = you want it but you're not sure.
Teacher tip	Model your own talk first (1 minute). Learners may read from paper at graduation. Goals are personal; "learn more English" is a great goal.

Week 15: Final Exam · Week 16: Graduation

See Section 7.

7. Midterm, Final, and Graduation

Same evening structure as Level 2 (Opening → review stations with speaking interviews → listening test before the break → grammar and writing after the break → can-do self-check). Level 3 changes: the teacher plays the audio **2 times**, the grammar test adds a short **"fix the mistake"** part, and there is a short **writing task**.

	Week 8: Midterm	Week 15: Final
Covers	Lessons 1–7: follow-up questions and *because / so*, describing people and object pronouns, *used to*, past continuous + *when / while*, *will* vs. *going to*, first conditional, *I'd like to* and *Could I / May I*	All lessons, focus on 8–13: possessive pronouns and *Whose*, *-ing* after *good at / interested in / enjoy*, sequence words and imperatives, *-ed / -ing* adjectives, *something / anything*, future forms
Review stations (6:10–6:30)	① Grammar Auction (correct / wrong sentences), ② Listening Replay (Lessons 4–7 audio), ③ Role-Play Cards (one per lesson), ④ Pronunciation Bingo	① Grammar Auction, ② Listening Replay (Lessons 10–13), ③ Role-Play Cards, ④ Talk Rehearsal (graduation talk)
Listening test (6:30–6:45)	10 items: a conversation about a small car accident and a return at a store (main idea, order of events, details). Circle / true-false / write one word. The teacher plays the audio 2 times.	10 items: a conversation that recycles a lost item, a job interview question, instructions, and a repair call. Same task types.
Grammar test (7:00–7:15)	20 items: 15 circle the answer (*used to / use to*, *was / were* + *-ing*, *'ll / going to*, *if* + present, *like / like to*, *him / her / them*), 5 fix the mistake	20 items: 15 circle (*mine / my*, *at cooking / at cook*, *-ed / -ing*, *something / anything*, sequence words, future forms), 5 fix the mistake
Writing task (7:15–7:25)	4–5 sentences: a short accident report **or** a text offering help (choose one), with one reason	4–5 sentences: a maintenance request **or** a short review of an event (choose one), with one reason
Speaking interview (4 min per pair)	Part 1: 2 baseline prompts each, with one follow-up from the interviewer. Part 2: pair task card: return an item at a service desk **or** make an *If..., we'll...* plan for a storm	Part 1: the same baseline prompts as Weeks 1–3, to show growth. Part 2: a mini job interview (*good at / interested in*) **or** a repair call
Rubric	Level 2's 1–3 rubric (Communication / Target grammar / Pronunciation and fluency). For Level 3, a **3 in Communication** means the learner gives reasons **and** asks or answers a follow-up question.	Same
Self-check	Can-do self-check + one goal	Can-do self-check; "Ready for Level 4" decision

> **Exam-night timing with 15 learners:** 8 pairs × 4 minutes ≈ 32 minutes of interviews. Start them during the review stations and continue during the grammar and writing tests. With 7–8 learners, about 16 minutes.

Proposed "Ready for Level 4" standard (confirm): attend at least 9 of the 13 lessons, complete the final, score 2 or higher in all rubric areas on the final speaking interview, and write a 4–5 sentence task that a reader can understand on the first reading. Learners who are not ready still graduate and are encouraged to repeat Level 3.

Week 16: Graduation. No new content. Each learner gives a **1–2 minute "Where I'm Going" talk** prepared in Lesson 13 (reading from paper is fine). Certificates of completion. Optional potluck: ask about allergies, and don't require anyone to bring food. Hand out a "Keep practicing" sheet with the website, QR codes for all audio, and local community resources.

8. Decisions (October 20, 2026) and Remaining Questions

All of the questions from the first draft are now decided. Decisions marked *(recommendation)* follow this plan's recommendation; please say if you want to change any of them.

1. **Icons: decided.** No instruction icons in any level (they are also being removed from Level 1). Level 3 instructions are short, plain English.
2. **Language support: decided.** No Spanish line and no "My language" line under instructions. Instead: a *My language* column on the New Words page, a task-words page with *Español* and *My language* columns, and on each Grammar page one short Spanish note plus one tip for speakers of other languages (Spanish on student pages only; teachers need no Spanish).
3. **Read & Write block: decided** *(recommendation)*. 7:17–7:30 is a standing Read & Write block; it is the first thing to shorten if class runs late.
4. **Audio: decided.** About 1.5 minutes, up to 3 speakers, natural speed. Each file plays the conversation once (it never repeats inside the file); the teacher plays it twice (gist, then details) and may play it again. Voices are synthetic reference voices only (no recordings of real people); female characters sound clearly female and male characters clearly male.
5. **Lesson 4: decided.** A simple, non-graphic car accident is the main story (a small crash, dents, no one hurt, no injury details). A minor workplace incident (wet floor, dropped box) is an optional alternative.
6. **Lesson 6 weather: decided** *(recommendation)*. Storms, a power outage, and a heat wave as the main examples; snow and floods as options a teacher can swap in for the local area.
7. **Lesson 2 word list: decided** *(recommendation)*. Hair, height, glasses, beards, clothes, and personality only; no weight, skin color, or age words.
8. **Rubric: decided** *(recommendation)*. Keep Level 2's three areas; a "3" in Communication requires reasons and a follow-up question.
9. **Writing on exams: decided** *(recommendation)*. A 4–5 sentence writing task on the midterm and final.
10. **"Ready for Level 4": decided** *(recommendation)*. The standard in Section 7, with the simple scale Meets / Almost / Not yet if grades are needed.
11. **Placement: decided** *(recommendation)*. The Section 2.1 placement chat. A standardized test can be added later if the program needs NRS reporting.
12. **Pictures with no good emoji: decided** *(recommendation)*. Labeled combinations of two emoji or a simple drawn form, as in Levels 1 and 2.
13. **Lesson order: decided** *(recommendation)*. Keep the order in Section 5.
14. **Title and website: decided** *(recommendation)*. Keep "Level 3"; same website as Levels 1–2 when it is published (nothing is published yet).

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